

Introduction to Artificial Intelligence Spring 2026: C S 470

Instructor

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TA hours and contact information can be found in Learning Suite (Content -> TA Hours)

Course Description

This course is an introduction to core areas of artificial intelligence.

Prerequisites

CS 312 & Math 313 & Stat 121; or CS 312 & Math 313 & Stat 201.

Website

All information pertaining to the course will be maintained on Learning Suite. Note that the posted schedule on Learning Suite is tentative and subject to change, so please refer to it frequently.

Discord

We will use a Discord server for the class. It is not required to join, but recommended if you want a more streamlined process for asking questions about homework, projects, etc. Details about how to join will be posted on Learning Suite shortly before the beginning of the semester. Please contact the instructor for any related questions.

Textbook

The textbook for the course is Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach, by Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig. Other readings will be posted on Learning Suite. Please note that the textbook is **optional**, and you should be able to find a free version online if you choose to read it. If you choose not to obtain the textbook, you should be able (and expected) to read the other readings posted on the class schedule. However, if you wish to learn more about each topic, the textbook can be a great resource.

Course Content

The following activities will be used to help you learn:

- Exams (20%): There will be a Midterm (10%) and Final (10%) exam. These exams will test your understanding of the AI techniques we address, as well as to select and set up the appropriate models for a given problem.
- Projects (50%): You will be expected to complete 4 lab projects, which will include math, programming, and analysis components
- Homework + Mini-projects (15%): Smaller assignments to reinforce concepts discussed in the class.

- **Big-Picture Discussions (15%):** To help round out your initial foray into artificial intelligence, you will read about and discuss a variety of big-picture topics in artificial intelligence.

Grading

You are encouraged to have fun with the course. You shouldn't let grades distract you from learning. Within a few months after the course, you likely won't remember or care what grade you got, but you will care about the insights you gained and how much fun you had (or didn't have).

That being said, you will receive a grade for this course. We have tried to design the course so that grades will correlate with what you learn and the capabilities you gain. Letter grades will be computed as follows:

A	93-100
A-	90-92
B+	87-89
B	83-86
B-	80-82
C+	77-79
C	73-76
C-	70-72
D+	67-69
D	63-66
D-	60-62
E	Below 60

The instructor reserves the right to lower the grading scale (e.g., the range for an A grade could be lowered to 92-100 rather than 93-100), but he will not raise it. In other words, any adjustment to the table above will not decrease anyone's letter grade.

Late Work

All students will receive 3 grace days that can be used at any point in the semester. Excluding Sundays and holidays, assignments turned in up to 3 days past the due date may receive full credit. After this, assignments will be deducted -10% per day late (excluding Sundays and holidays) for up to -50%. If there are any unusual circumstances, extensions may be granted at the instructors discretion.

Working Together

You are encouraged to work with others on course activities if you so desire. But don't rely on others to complete course activities for you (i.e., don't be a jerk). The value of course activities lies in what you learn from them. If you don't do them properly, you won't learn properly. So don't copy anyone else's work or rely on them to do the work for you. However, working with others can facilitate learning and can be more fun, so use such opportunities if you feel so inclined. If you see a good reason to violate these limits, contact the instructor.

University Policies

Honor Code

In keeping with the principles of the BYU Honor Code, students are expected to be honest in all of their academic work. Academic honesty means, most fundamentally, that any work you present as your own must in fact be your own work and not that of another. Violations of this principle may result in a failing grade in the course and additional disciplinary action by the university. Students are also expected to adhere to the Dress and Grooming Standards. Adherence demonstrates respect for yourself and others and ensures an effective learning and working environment. It is the university's expectation, and every instructor's expectation in class, that each student will abide by all Honor Code standards. Please call the Honor Code Office at 422-2847 if you have questions about those standards.

Preventing & Responding to Sexual Misconduct

In accordance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, Brigham Young University prohibits unlawful sex discrimination against any participant in its education programs or activities. The university also prohibits sexual harassment—including sexual violence—committed by or against students, university employees, and visitors to campus. As outlined in university policy, sexual harassment, dating violence, domestic violence, sexual assault, and stalking are considered forms of "Sexual Misconduct" prohibited by the university. University policy requires all university employees in a teaching, managerial, or supervisory role to report all incidents of Sexual Misconduct that come to their attention in any way, including but not limited to face-to-face conversations, a written class assignment or paper, class discussion, email, text, or social media post. Incidents of Sexual Misconduct should be reported to the Title IX Coordinator at t9coordinator@byu.edu or (801) 422-8692. Reports may also be submitted through EthicsPoint at <https://titleix.byu.edu/report> or 1-888-238-1062 (24-hours a day). BYU offers confidential resources for those affected by Sexual Misconduct, including the university's Victim Advocate, as well as a number of non-confidential resources and services that may be helpful. Additional information about Title IX, the university's Sexual Misconduct Policy, reporting requirements, and resources can be found at <http://titleix.byu.edu> or by contacting the university's Title IX Coordinator.

Student Disability

Brigham Young University is committed to providing a working and learning atmosphere that reasonably accommodates qualified persons with disabilities. If you have any disability which may impair your ability to complete this course successfully, please contact the University Accessibility Center (UAC), 2170 WSC or 422-2767. Reasonable academic accommodations are reviewed for all students who have qualified, documented disabilities. The UAC can also assess students for learning, attention, and emotional concerns. Services are coordinated with the student and instructor by the UAC. If you need assistance or if you feel you have been unlawfully discriminated against on the basis of disability, you may seek resolution through established grievance policy and procedures by contacting the Equal Employment Office at 422-5895, D-285 ASB.